A HUMAN–AI LOOP WORKBOOK · PAPER PROTOTYPE

Collaboration by Design

Building human-AI teams that make us sharper

Sidebar Spark roundtable · Kalla Calistoga · October 30, 2026
Hosted by Maura K. Randall

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4 Make it yours

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Our Team and Our Project stay on the table, next to this book.

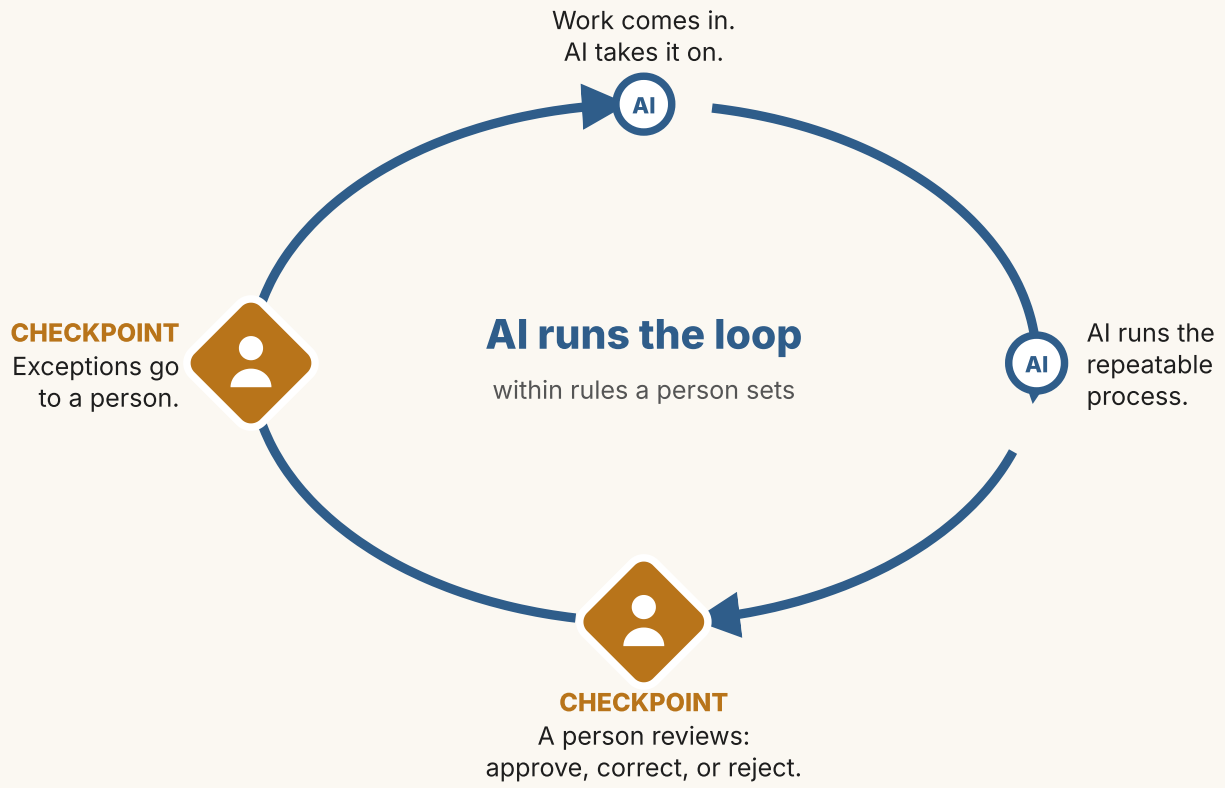
THIS WORKBOOK BELONGS TO

OUR TEAM

PATTERN 1 · A COMMON HUMAN-IN-THE-LOOP MODEL

Review at defined checkpoints.

Keeps people in the process.



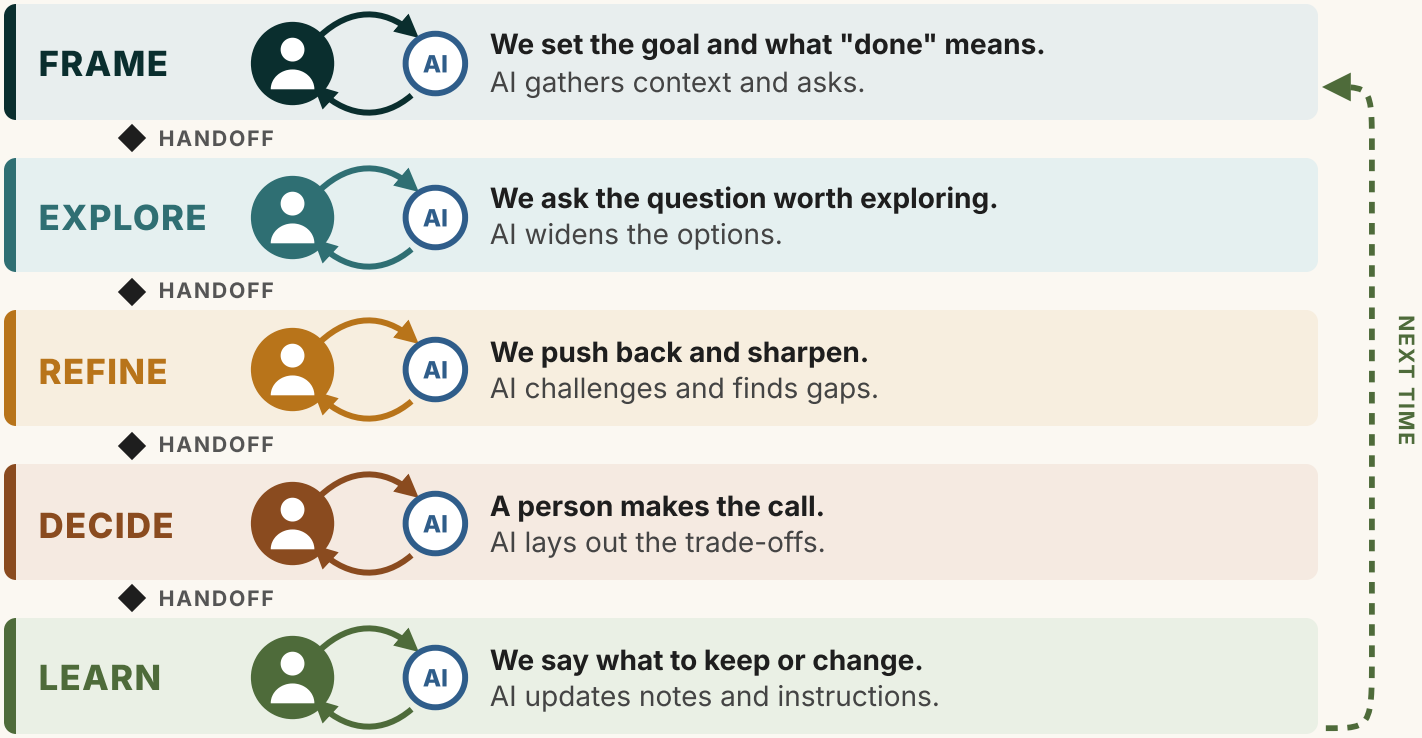
WHEN THE PERSON COMES IN	At defined review points, or when an exception occurs
THE PERSON'S ROLE	Sets the rules; reviews, approves, or handles exceptions
AI'S ROLE	Runs the repeatable process within those rules
BUILT FOR	Consistency and scale. Repeatable, rules-based work with clear exceptions.
EXAMPLE	*Routine customer update. AI fills an approved template from system data; a person checks exceptions before it is sent.*

A checkpoint shows where a person reviewed the work.

PATTERN 2 · THE HUMAN–AI LOOP

Lead from the start.

Keeps people leading the work.



A loop inside every phase. People lead, AI contributes, and a person makes the call.

WHEN THE PERSON COMES IN	From the start and throughout the work
THE PERSON'S ROLE	Provides intent, context, judgment, and the final call
AI'S ROLE	Contributes, challenges, and drafts alongside us
BUILT FOR	Collaboration. Creative, strategic, judgment-heavy work.
EXAMPLE	*Sensitive customer update. We frame the intent and audience, explore wording with AI, challenge the risks, and a person decides what to say.*

It does not, by itself, show how human judgment shaped it.

Make it yours

Build the team once. Design one real project. Leave with a model you can test.

PHASES ARE LENSES Start anywhere. Revisit any phase. Add only what matters. **Blank is allowed.**

1 Build your team

Name each player. On Our Team, capture roles, shared rules, boundaries, and what you ask of one another.

2 Pick real work

Choose work you can picture clearly. Name the project type, the work, the outcome, and how much judgment it needs.

3 Design one phase at a time

Use the Inspiration Sheets for language. Borrow, adapt, or write your own on a blank label. Place only what matters.

4 Name the handoffs

In Decide, mark who makes the call, who may redirect the work, and who checks AI work before it moves on.

5 Look across the pattern

What repeats across phases? Move team-wide rules, boundaries, or requests back to Our Team.

6 Capture the design

With your OK, Maura photographs Our Team and Our Project for your read-back. Keep confidential details off the page.

Mistakes welcome. Move or replace a label.

Don'ts come in flavors

EXAMPLES

Not worth my time: I could take the notes. AI does it better and faster.

Not my skill: I QA the code, but I don't write it.

Not without my OK: AI drafts the update. It doesn't send it until I approve.

Not ever: AI doesn't contact stakeholders directly.

A good "don't" says why the boundary exists.

Your read-back, by Friday, Nov 6

Prepared with my AI teammates, Soph (Claude) and CP (ChatGPT). I review every one and send it.

- Your design in plain language
- What's working
- Up to three things worth considering
- One question for your team

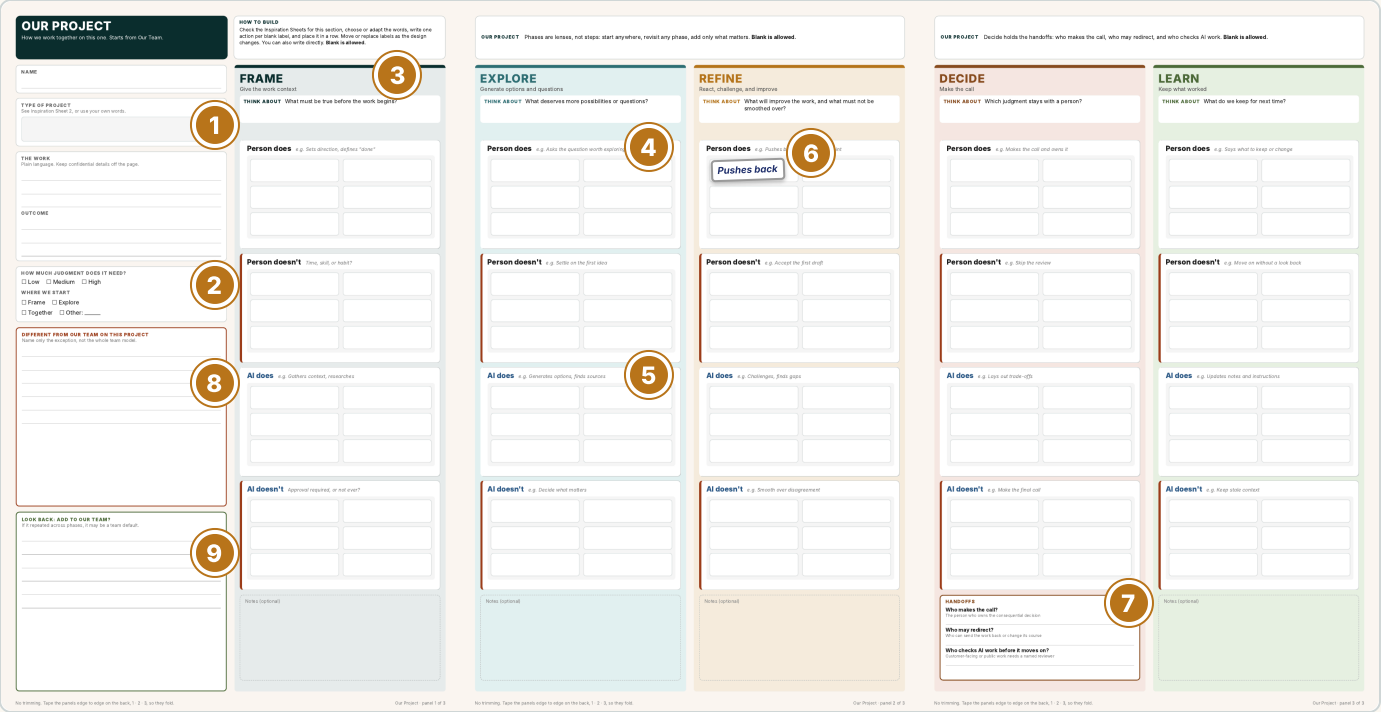
This is a paper prototype.

I'm building the online version of this kit. Your edits are part of the design. Scan to join the alpha, or visit maurakrandall.github.io/workbook

More from Maura and her AI teammates: thehumanailoop.com

How to use Our Project

Three panels, taped side by side. Add only what matters. Blank is allowed.



1. **Name the work.** Type of project, the work, and the outcome.
2. **Set the bar.** How much judgment the work needs, and where we start.
3. **Five phases, used as lenses.** Start anywhere. Each has one question to think about.
4. **Person does and doesn't.** One action per label. For a don't, note why: time, skill, or habit.
5. **AI does and doesn't.** The contribution, not the product name. For a don't: not without approval, or not ever?
6. **One blank label, one action.** Write it in pen, then place it. Two fit side by side. Move or replace a label anytime.
7. **Handoffs.** Who makes the call, who may redirect, and who checks AI work before it moves on.
8. **Different from Our Team.** Only the exception on this project.
9. **Look back.** What repeats across phases may belong on Our Team.

Need ideas? Use the Inspiration Sheets, starting on the next page. Borrow, adapt, or write your own.

INSPIRATION SHEET 1 OF 5

Our Team

For: the Our Team sheet

Examples, not answers. Borrow one, adapt it, or write your own. Use only what matters. Blank is allowed.

Role on the team

People and AI can both hold a role.

- Product manager
- Team lead
- Designer
- Developer
- Tech architect
- Researcher
- Writer or editor
- Analyst
- Project manager
- Thinking partner
- Challenger
- Reviewer

Restricted from

Firewalls, approvals, sensitive data.

- Customer data
- Financials
- People and HR data
- Sending anything outside the team
- Unreleased plans
- Systems it cannot log in to

Runs on (AI)

The product, in plain words.

- Claude
- ChatGPT
- Gemini
- Microsoft Copilot
- Claude Code
- Codex
- A custom agent
- An internal company tool

What we ask of each other

People and AI alike.

- Name your assumptions
- Challenge each other
- Push back
- Give detailed feedback
- Be polite but honest
- Push me
- Have fun

Our rules

Non-negotiables that travel across projects.

- Nothing is final until a person approves it
- Show your sources
- Say when you are not sure
- Agreement isn't the goal
- Speed is not more important than quality
- Protect confidential information

INSPIRATION SHEET 2 OF 5

Our Project

For: the setup panel, and the five phases

Examples, not answers. Borrow one, adapt it, or write your own. Use only what matters. Blank is allowed.

Type of project

Name the work in familiar language.

- Newsletter
- MVP or product feature
- Personal assistant
- Board update
- Strategy or decision memo
- Customer research
- Marketing campaign
- Hiring plan
- Internal training
- Event or convening
- Operating process
- Analysis or forecast
- Policy or guidance
- Customer support
- Change initiative
- Your own

Questions that sharpen each phase

The first question matches Think about on each panel. Phases are lenses, not steps.

FRAME

What must be true before the work begins?

Go deeper: What context, constraints, and definition of done must a person supply?

EXPLORE

What deserves more possibilities or questions?

Go deeper: Where is human curiosity, lived experience, or dissent especially valuable?

REFINE

What will improve the work, and what must not be smoothed over?

Go deeper: What should a person challenge, edit, or refuse to smooth over?

DECIDE

Which judgment stays with a person?

Go deeper: Which judgment stays with a person, and who owns the consequence?

LEARN

What do we keep for next time?

Go deeper: Who decides what is kept, changed, documented, or retired?

INSPIRATION SHEET 3 OF 5

Person

For: the Person does and Person doesn't rows

Examples, not answers. Borrow one, adapt it, or write your own. Use only what matters. Blank is allowed.

Person does

Judgment, context, relationship, accountability.

- Sets direction
- Defines what "done" means
- Asks the question worth asking
- Shares context
- Owns the outcome
- Makes the call
- Reviews
- Approves before it goes out
- Edits
- Pushes back
- Can redirect
- Talks to customers
- Talks to stakeholders
- Sets success measures
- Prioritizes
- Does the final check
- Decides what to keep
- Updates Our Team

Person doesn't

Name the reason: time, skill, or habit.

- Take notes · **TIME**
- Format and tidy · **TIME**
- Write every first draft · **TIME**
- Track status by hand · **TIME**
- Synthesize long documents · **TIME**
- Write code · **SKILL**
- Design the visuals · **SKILL**
- Analyze raw data · **SKILL**
- Over-direct · **HABIT**
- Accept the first draft · **HABIT**
- Skip the review · **HABIT**
- Rubber-stamp · **HABIT**
- Hand off without context · **HABIT**
- Decide without input · **HABIT**
- Hide the AI's role · **HABIT**
- Move on without a look back · **HABIT**

INSPIRATION SHEET 4 OF 5

AI

For: the AI does and AI doesn't rows

Examples, not answers. Borrow one, adapt it, or write your own. Use only what matters. Blank is allowed.

AI does

Describe the contribution, not the product name.

- Gathers context
- Researches, with sources
- Summarizes
- Synthesizes findings
- Generates options
- Drafts first versions
- Takes notes
- Challenges my thinking
- Pushes back
- Flags drift
- Fact-checks
- Finds gaps
- Analyzes data
- Organizes
- Runs QA checks
- Tracks status
- Updates notes and instructions
- Gives input on decisions

AI doesn't

Not without approval, or not ever?

- Send without approval
- Publish without approval
- Contact stakeholders directly
- Make the final call
- Change scope without asking
- Edit approved work
- Ship code without review
- Use restricted data
- Guess when unsure
- Agree just to agree
- Set priorities without input
- Speak for me
- Spend money
- Delete without approval
- Share outside the team
- Drop the sources
- Smooth over disagreement
- Override a person

INSPIRATION SHEET 5 OF 5

Handoffs

For: the Decide handoffs, and the look back

Examples, not answers. Borrow one, adapt it, or write your own. Use only what matters. Blank is allowed.

Who holds what

Make authority visible where it matters.

- Makes the call
- Gives input
- Approves
- Reviews
- Can redirect
- Can override
- Checks before release
- Receives the draft
- Is kept informed
- Keeps what we learned

Before the work moves on

The questions in the Decide handoff box.

Who makes the call?
Name the person who owns the consequential decision.

Who may redirect?
Name who can send the work back or change its course.

Who checks AI work?
Anything customer-facing or public needs a named reviewer.

What returns to Our Team?
If it repeated across phases, it may be a team default.

Write in black. Move or replace a label whenever the design changes.

NOTES

What surprised us, what we want to try first, and what to bring back to our team.

KEEP GOING

This is a paper prototype. Your edits are part of the design.

I'm building the online version of this kit. Scan to join the alpha, or visit maurakrandall.github.io/workbook.

More from Maura and her AI teammates: thehumanailoop.com

OUR TEAM

How we work together across projects. Set it once, revisit it when needed.

NAME

Labels every photo

BUILD THE ROSTER

Ideas on Inspiration Sheet 1. A stand holds each player's name. This page holds the rest. Write directly; to revise, cover the earlier words with a blank label.

STAND HERE

Player 1 · name on the stand | Runs on (AI) | Role on the team | Can

☐ Person ☐ AI | ☐ Teammate ☐ Tool ☐ Other | Restricted from | Can't

STAND HERE

Player 2 · name on the stand | Runs on (AI) | Role on the team | Can

☐ Person ☐ AI | ☐ Teammate ☐ Tool ☐ Other | Restricted from | Can't

STAND HERE

Player 3 · name on the stand | Runs on (AI) | Role on the team | Can

☐ Person ☐ AI | ☐ Teammate ☐ Tool ☐ Other | Restricted from | Can't

STAND HERE

Player 4 · name on the stand | Runs on (AI) | Role on the team | Can

☐ Person ☐ AI | ☐ Teammate ☐ Tool ☐ Other | Restricted from | Can't

STAND HERE

Player 5 · name on the stand | Runs on (AI) | Role on the team | Can

☐ Person ☐ AI | ☐ Teammate ☐ Tool ☐ Other | Restricted from | Can't

STAND HERE

Player 6 · name on the stand | Runs on (AI) | Role on the team | Can

☐ Person ☐ AI | ☐ Teammate ☐ Tool ☐ Other | Restricted from | Can't

OUR RULES

Non-negotiables that travel across projects. Examples:

- Nothing is final until a person approves it
- Show your sources
- Say when you are not sure
- Agreement isn't the goal

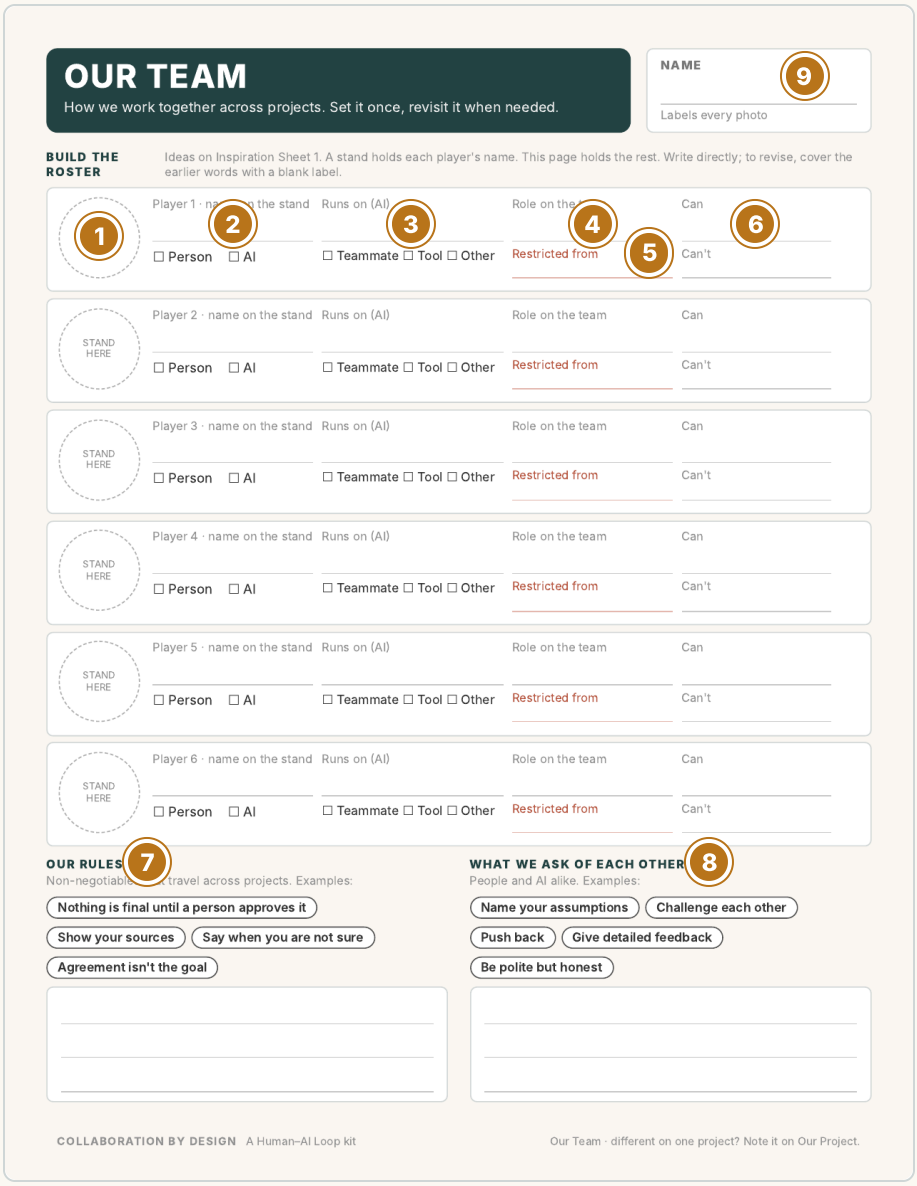
WHAT WE ASK OF EACH OTHER

People and AI alike. Examples:

- Name your assumptions
- Challenge each other
- Push back
- Give detailed feedback
- Be polite but honest

How to use Our Team

Look at this side while we walk through an example. Then flip the sheet and build yours.



OUR TEAM

How we work together across projects. Set it once, revisit it when needed.

NAME 9

Labels every photo

BUILD THE ROSTER

Ideas on Inspiration Sheet 1. A stand holds each player's name. This page holds the rest. Write directly; to revise, cover the earlier words with a blank label.

1 — Player 1 · name on the stand 2 | Runs on (AI) 3 | Role on the team 4 | Can 6

☐ Person ☐ AI | ☐ Teammate ☐ Tool ☐ Other | Restricted from 5 | Can't

STAND HERE — Player 2 · name on the stand | Runs on (AI) | Role on the team | Can

☐ Person ☐ AI | ☐ Teammate ☐ Tool ☐ Other | Restricted from | Can't

STAND HERE — Player 3 · name on the stand | Runs on (AI) | Role on the team | Can

☐ Person ☐ AI | ☐ Teammate ☐ Tool ☐ Other | Restricted from | Can't

STAND HERE — Player 4 · name on the stand | Runs on (AI) | Role on the team | Can

☐ Person ☐ AI | ☐ Teammate ☐ Tool ☐ Other | Restricted from | Can't

STAND HERE — Player 5 · name on the stand | Runs on (AI) | Role on the team | Can

☐ Person ☐ AI | ☐ Teammate ☐ Tool ☐ Other | Restricted from | Can't

STAND HERE — Player 6 · name on the stand | Runs on (AI) | Role on the team | Can

☐ Person ☐ AI | ☐ Teammate ☐ Tool ☐ Other | Restricted from | Can't

OUR RULES 7

Non-negotiables that travel across projects. Examples:

- Nothing is final until a person approves it
- Show your sources
- Say when you are not sure
- Agreement isn't the goal

WHAT WE ASK OF EACH OTHER 8

People and AI alike. Examples:

- Name your assumptions
- Challenge each other
- Push back
- Give detailed feedback
- Be polite but honest

COLLABORATION BY DESIGN A Human–AI Loop kit

Our Team · different on one project? Note it on Our Project.

1. **Stand here.** Each player's stand goes in the circle.
2. **Player.** The name on the stand. Person or AI.
3. **Runs on.** For an AI, the tool or model. Then teammate, tool, or other.
4. **Role on the team.** What this player is here for.
5. **Restricted from.** A hard limit, like data it can't see.
6. **Can and can't.** One ability or limit that matters.
7. **Our rules.** Non-negotiables on every project.
8. **What we ask of each other.** How we want people and AI to show up.
9. **Name.** Yours. It labels every photo.

A first pass, not a form. Start with yourself, one or two teammates who matter most, each player's role, and one can, can't, or restriction. Blank is allowed.

Need ideas? Use Inspiration Sheet 1, in the workbook.

OUR PROJECT

How we work together on this one. Starts from Our Team.

HOW TO BUILD

Check the Inspiration Sheets for this section, choose or adapt the words, write one action per blank label, and place it in a row. Move or replace labels as the design changes. You can also write directly. **Blank is allowed.**

NAME

_____

TYPE OF PROJECT

See Inspiration Sheet 2, or use your own words.

THE WORK

Plain language. Keep confidential details off the page.

_____

_____

_____

OUTCOME

_____

_____

_____

HOW MUCH JUDGMENT DOES IT NEED?

☐ Low ☐ Medium ☐ High

WHERE WE START

☐ Frame ☐ Explore

☐ Together ☐ Other: _____

DIFFERENT FROM OUR TEAM ON THIS PROJECT

FRAME

Give the work context

THINK ABOUT What must be true before the work begins?

Person does

e.g. Sets direction, defines "done"

Person doesn't

Time, skill, or habit?

LOOK BACK: ADD TO OUR TEAM?
If it repeated across phases, it may be a team default.

AI does *e.g. Gathers context, researches*

AI doesn't *Approval required, or not ever?*

Notes (optional)

OUR PROJECT Phases are lenses, not steps: start anywhere, revisit any phase, add only what matters. **Blank is allowed.**

EXPLORE

Generate options and questions

THINK ABOUT What deserves more possibilities or questions?

Person does

e.g. Asks the question worth exploring

Person doesn't

e.g. Settle on the first idea

REFINE

React, challenge, and improve

THINK ABOUT What will improve the work, and what must not be smoothed over?

Person does

e.g. Pushes back, sharpens the point

Person doesn't

e.g. Accept the first draft

AI does *e.g. Generates options, finds sources*

AI does *e.g. Challenges, finds gaps*

AI doesn't *e.g. Set priorities without input*

AI doesn't *e.g. Smooth over disagreement*

Notes (optional)

Notes (optional)

OUR PROJECT Decide holds the handoffs: who makes the call, who may redirect, and who checks AI work. **Blank is allowed.**

DECIDE

Make the call

THINK ABOUT Which judgment stays with a person?

Person does

e.g. Makes the call and owns it

Person doesn't

e.g. Skip the review

LEARN

Keep what worked

THINK ABOUT What do we keep for next time?

Person does

e.g. Says what to keep or change

Person doesn't

e.g. Move on without a look back

AI does *e.g. Lays out trade-offs*

AI doesn't *e.g. Make the final call*

HANDOFFS

Who makes the call?
The person who owns the consequential decision

Who may redirect?
Who can send the work back or change its course

Who checks AI work before it moves on?
Customer-facing or public work needs a named reviewer

AI does *e.g. Updates notes and instructions*

AI doesn't *e.g. Keep stale context*

Notes (optional)